GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

October 3rd, 2025
Week 40
Volume 277, Issue 1205

Highlights:

Decline continues.

- **Still not over!**
- **HKC hopes.**
- **Upgrades ongoing.**
- **Indian woes.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

I have stood on a mountain of "no's" for one "yes".

– Barbara Smith

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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HALLOWEEN ALREADY?!

As we enter October, global markets are ready registering spooks across the board, marking a drastic debut into Week 41. While inflationary numbers from the various locations pertinent to this Newsletter are still incoming, reports from both Turkey and Pakistan suggest they climbed through September, likely laying out the groundwork for a spooky October at both locations. Currencies too are back on the scary charts as oil finds itself slipping on its own spills and trading markets recorded the worst drop since January 2025 as the entire index declined nearly 16% for the week. Oil, on the other hand, tripped towards USD 60 / barrel and is nearly 20% lower than the same time last year as capes, panamax and even supramax indices saw the lower side of last week.

And expectedly, steel plate prices at the various recycling destinations also reflected last week's positions with India still the only one going down the water slide.

Decidedly slipping into the micro, Indian sub-continent ship recycling destinations did not escape the incoming dark of the month as nearly all markets reported dithering numbers of arrivals at respective anchorages while recyclers continue to look for a "lift me" moment, after what has been an unexpectedly woeful 2025 of declining fundamentals, supply, prices, and sentiment. Indeed, this has turned out to be one of the slowest years for ship recycling in over a decade – and it's still not over!

Markets have resumed a tonnage scarcity that that is struggling to keep ailing yards active, which themselves remain burdened by HKC requirements, delays, and regulatory changes. Ship recyclers must truly wonder whether all of the HKC upgrades and requirements were in vain when in the years prior, the operation of ship recycling was a fantastically well-oiled machine. Moreover, while a limited tonnage supply has been the flavor of the fruit of late, the combined present where the average age of vessels is creeping past 30 years old and new vessels continue to hit the water from newbuilding yards **will** see a phase out of vintage vessels in the years ahead. But the year(s) ahead has been a festering situation that's only been getting worse since 2022. So, 2027 now?

With 18 HKC approved yards in Bangladesh and another 3 set to follow this month, Pakistan remains absent on its HKC scoreboard as the Gadani Gang continues to work hard upgrading their facilities after a slow pre-HKC start, all while Alang yards are all dressed up with nowhere to go. Pricing remains in Pakistan's favor with provisional DASR certs playing referee on the state of incoming tonnage. India's tough times don't seem to end as currency and steel woes continue to sink the 'sentiment ship' across September. Turkey has turned into an absentee landlord, having local yards open for tonnage from Western ports but absent for the rest of the world. Oh, and the reported possibility of over 300 containers being earmarked for a 'grey fleet' designation? Spicy!

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 40 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

SCORCHED EARTH!

Most inactive.

As the lowest placed and most inactive global ship recycling market by far, it was no surprise to see Bangladeshi buyers swerving towards any hints of meaningful business this week, especially as local port position should've essentially marked itself **empty** had it not been for the lone wolf that's been idling outside for about 2 months now.

Empty yards.

Unfortunately, for the domestic ship recycling community, the feeling that the extent of the hard work, pressure, and investments expended towards yard upgrades in order to get in line with the standards of the HKC that resulted in them otherwise missing out on units during a time when the supply of vessels itself has been marginalized by Trump's tariff trainwrecks that have been hammering the nation state of late. Add to it the probability of an inflationary hike and thereby more expensive financing could just cripple a market that is also battling funky fundamentals and aggressive pricing from regional competition, Chattogram Choppers seem like they're walking into scorched earth territory for Q4 2025.

Local steel plate prices meanwhile remain stranded at a comparatively stronger USD 520/Ton, likely due to local recyclers holding pricing firm on their stockpile resales until steel mills buckle, which really remains to be seen now that domestic steel factories have now gotten a taste of cheaper steel imports. The currency too continues to dance on week after week as it loses another 5 basis points this week and end it at BDT 121.70. The silver lining to the currency woes? They've managed to remain within a BDT 3 limit for the last couple of months.

Time will come.

With no infrastructure projects announced as yet (going on over 12 months since the collapse of the last regime) and the future of the country hanging under the fragile control of the interim government for the next 4+ months, Bangladesh's ship recycling fraternity seems as though it could cripple under the weight of its own HKC adventures, especially as more local yards come online and competition seeps in from the macro to the micro.

Of note, while the rains have seemingly ended and a resumption of daily activities ensues, local chop shops conversely find themselves amidst declining sentiments. Nevertheless, the time will come for Bangladesh to get back to buying and all of the HKC approved yards will be rewarded with tonnage as the quantum of the industry's increasingly aging fleet comes knocking. Until then, it remains a wish and a prayer.

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A wish and a prayer.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

WOEFUL SLIDE!

Under pressure.

It has been a tumultuous time for the perennially nervy Alang market, with a drastically depreciating Indian Rupee that has been stealing the limelight as well as ship recycler's peace of mind for weeks on end given that the Rupee has broken past all historical records and seemingly settled in the high Rs. 88s against the U.S. Dollar. In fact, even this week, The US$ gained 12 basis points against the Rupee, winding the week down at Rs. 88.74, inching back towards the increasingly dreaded Rs. 89 mark.

Noise to LDT ratio.

Constantly sliding steel plate prices that fell another USD 6/Ton and end the week at USD 402/Ton (well below current offerings) are also placing increasing pressure on current offerings as tabled levels are being reversed across active negotiations. Moreover, the fate of recent high-priced fixtures from ever-exuberant cash buyers also stand to strain upcoming deliveries and thereby, subsequent negotiations, especially if prices do fall and owners and cash buyers with inventory on hand start to chase prices down at a time Bangladesh is already a mere USD 10/Ton below and Pakistani recyclers noise to LDT ratio remains misaligned.

As a result, Alang sentiments remain under severe pressure despite being the most active sub-continent recycling destination. Moreover, with most of the 100+ operating yards in Alang already HKC approved and also celebrating another week as the most active waterfront across recent weeks, it has been a curious few months watching competitors get up to speed with HKC infrastructure upgrades, whilst supply suffers and Alang buyers are yet to take full advantage of their HKC status.

Chem tanker sold.

One sale was however recorded for the week as the BOW CEDAR (11,043 LDT) from Norwegian owners Odfjell managed to fetch a decent USD 940/LT LDT, thanks to the prevalence of 2,300 tons of solid stainless steel on board and 700 tons of bunkers on delivery, to a select HKC yard, the second such sale from the group in the last month.

As it stands, with both Bangladesh and Pakistan likely down and out for October, Alang retains the "go to" spot for ship recycling – and will likely be over the next upcoming weeks.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
BOW CEDAR	Tanker	11,043	USD 940/LT LDT (with abt 2,300 Ts solid stainless steel and 700 Ts bunkers ROB)

PAKISTAN

FLIPPANT!

Limited higher LDT.

Despite securing several handymax bulkers for recycling over the last month, domestic demand has yet to reach anywhere near satiated levels in Pakistan - and certainly for the preferred yet absent, large(r) LDT units (such as capes and even panamax bulkers) that have somehow managed to evade Pakistani shores over recent times and end up in Indian hands, despite Gadani being the highest placed market for pricing across all ship recycling locations.

Ongoing yard upgrades meanwhile highlight just how much remains to be done here and get domestic ship recycling facilities fully HKC ratified / approved, despite the temporary issuance of provisional DASR certificates continuing to assist local recyclers with their buying endeavors whilst they continue to demonstrate progress infrastructure upgrades, which curiously has yet to translate into Pakistan's first internationally recognized HKC faclitily.

Still top.

In the interim, small(er) LDT are receiving the same treatment as out of Bangladesh while even India is starting to price-cut their offerings on such tonnage due to the same issues that have been hampering sub-continent ship recycling destinations i.e. longer government and bank approvals as for larger LDT vessels, sanctioned units checks, and greater chances of steel wastage / loss during the recycling process of smaller vessels when compared to their larger brethren, expensive financing, and currency woes amidst flippant global fundamentals.

No go for small LDT.

While local steel plate prices have managed to stay steady above USD 600/Ton (currently USD 100/ton higher than Bangladesh at USD 620/Ton) for a healthy part of 2025, not much is there to write home about from this market. The PKR, like the INR, has been hemorrhaging value for a majority of the year as it finds itself devaluing from the highs of region PKR 276 down to PKR 283 against the U.S. Dollar at the end of the week. But skyrocketing inflation is what will hit Pakistan in the economic belly as it nearly doubled from 3% in August to 5.4% as September closed.

Thanks Trump!

What lies ahead in October is the same as what Bangladesh will likely to face i.e. a tight 4 weeks, which in of itself seems to forecast a tonnage full month (if that is even such a thing anymore) for India.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

STUFFY!

Silent Q4?

Like the Gadani Gang, Aliaga recyclers find themselves not only facing a currency that has been on a mission to eventually cross the TRY 50 mark as it lost a whopping 27 basis points against the U.S. Dollar this week and closed it out at TRY 41.70, but it was also domestic inflation that resulted in a meerkat moment for local recyclers as it reportedly went up from 32.95% to nearly 33.30%.

While the rise in of itself may not seem as drastic, but to an already stagnant and stuffy ship recycling environment, the possibility of more expensive loans on marginally available tonnage is certainly a double-gut punch.

Silent Q4?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 40 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	India	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *As long as you legally obtain human flesh or limbs, cannibalism is allowed in the Netherlands.*
- *The short-horned lizard squirts blood out of its eyes — at a distance of up to three feet — to confuse predators. However, the blood contains a chemical that makes dogs, wolves, and coyotes noxious. Love that.*
- *A rainbow on Venus is called a "glory."*
- *Frogs use their eyes to help them swallow their meals. When a frog swallows' food, its eyes pull down to the roof of their mouth to help push the food down its throat.*
- *Human brains are constantly eating themselves. To "cleanse" the system, cells will smother and consume smaller cells or molecules in a process called phagocytosis.*
- *The fear of long words is called hippopotomonstrosesquippedaliophobia. After seeing that, I'm scared, too.*
- *Ants don't have lungs. Instead, they breathe through tiny holes on the sides of their bodies called spiracles.*
- *When lightning strikes, the air it passes through can reach up to 50,000ºF — five times hotter than the sun's surface.*
- *Due to thermal expansion, the Eiffel Tower can "grow" up to six inches in the summer.*
- *Tigers don't just have striped fur but skin, too! If you were to shave a tiger, you'd find identical striped markings as if they were tattoos.*
- *If you go to the sky deck of the Willis Tower in Chicago on a clear day, you can see four other US states: Illinois, Michigan, Indiana, and Wisconsin.*
- *A blue whale's heartbeat can be heard from two miles away.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 02 – Dussehra / Gandhi Jayanthi October 03 – Durga Puja October 22 – Diwali	October 05 – October 13 October 20 – October 26

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 01 & 02 – Durga Puja	October 06 – October 09 October 20 – October 23

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
October 24 – Founding Day	October 28 & 29 – Republic Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of September 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ali S	4,869	Buk Carrier	Arrived September 22
2	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
3	Lady L	5,827	Reefer	Arrived September 28
4	Nirvana	9,623	Oil Tanker	Arrived May 07
5	Trut	2,700	General Cargo	Arrived September 27
Total Tonnage		43,020		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
		7,809		

GADANI - Port Position as of September 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Eena 1	1,444	General Cargo	Arrived September 27
Total Tonnage		1,444		

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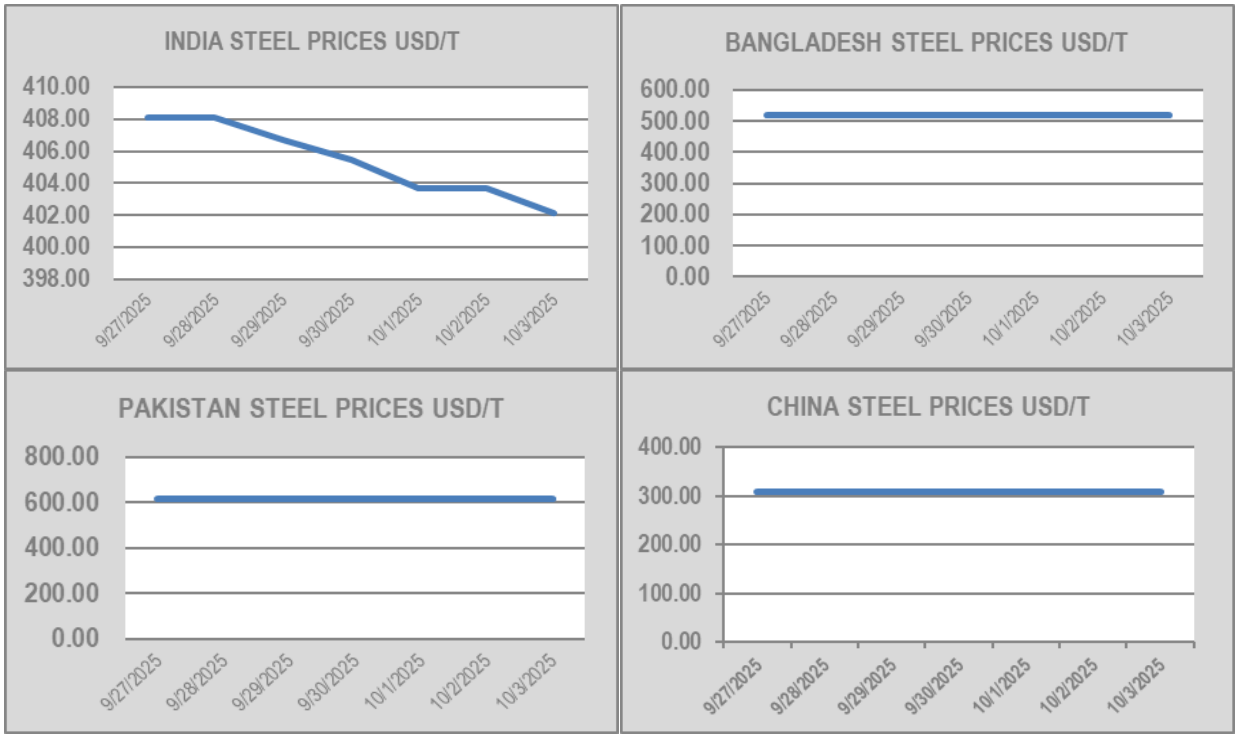
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/27/2025	408.07	36,200.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/28/2025	408.07	36,200.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/29/2025	406.71	36,100.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/30/2025	405.50	36,000.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
10/1/2025	403.65	35,800.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
10/2/2025	403.65	35,800.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
10/3/2025	402.12	35,700.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17



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